

these gadgets are not designed in house, rather they are developed by third party developers.

There are a lot of themes and colours available, as well as the option to change the templates. All these features are also referred to as “Power Toys”. Every time your contacts upload their Spaces, he or she pops up in your Space under the “Newly Updated Spaces” heading. Blogging is big on Windows Spaces. Members can



A default Spaces profile

leave messages or can chat using Messenger. You can also upload photos. Videos can be played using the Windows Media Player gadget which can be embedded in your Spaces page.

Live Spaces has several settings for security and privacy. You can control access to your media depending on who the visitor is. These settings can be changed anytime. Your Spaces page may also be made public or private, only to be accessed by your friends. You can also access the information about visitors to your page, statistics like where are they coming from and how many people visited you during the last day or the last week. Windows Live Spaces reportedly censors the seven bad words (we can't print them either) but has attracted criticism for censoring words like democracy and freedom on its Chinese portal.

If you do most of your e-mailing using hotmail accounts, and if you have many friends who use Live Messenger, then Windows Live Spaces offers you an easy way to get started on social networking. But we found features here limited in comparison to other sites like MySpace and Bebo, against whom Live Spaces is positioned.